

Constitution of the GIS and Mapping Club

Article I: Name

This organization shall be called and recognized by all as the GIS and Mapping Club.

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of the GIS and Mapping Club is to:

1. Promote education, awareness, and hands-on experience in geospatial technologies like GIS (Geographic Information Systems).
2. Engage students in interdisciplinary collaboration, applying knowledge from various disciplines and majors on campus for spatial analysis, mapping, and enhancing campus sustainability.
3. Enhance students' soft and technical skills through organizing workshops, guest lectures, and presentation and implementation of projects.
4. Provide opportunities for professional development and networking with GIS professionals in several disciplines through participation in regional conferences and bootcamps.

Article III: Affiliations

This organization is a recognized organization at Furman University and adheres to all University policies as set forth in the Furman University Student Handbook.

Article IV: Membership

In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

To be considered for a leadership role, students must have consistent attendance and active participation in the activities of the club.

Article V: Officers

The GIS and Mapping Club will comprise five officers: President, Vice President, Social Media Manager, Treasurer, and Secretary. Any member with consistent attendance at meetings and events will be eligible to run for any of these executive positions. Officers shall not serve for more than two consecutive terms.

Article VI: Advisor

The GIS and Mapping Club shall have one or more advisors. The club advisor(s) shall serve as a resource and mentor to members of the club. This includes but is not limited to providing educational materials and connecting members to GIS opportunities, when possible. The advisor(s) will not have voting privileges and shall not have a controlling interest in the operations of the club.

Article VII: Meetings

General body meetings shall be held regularly. The meeting dates and times shall be decided at the beginning of each semester by the officers.

Article VIII: Finance

The organization shall receive funding from the Student Government Association. Members will not be required to pay dues or contribute to the club's funding in any way.

Article IX: Amendments

Amendments to the Constitution and Bylaws may be proposed by any officer or member in good standing. Proposals for amending the constitution must be submitted in writing to club officers and discussed at a general meeting. A majority vote of the club's officers is required for adoption of this amendment.

By-Laws

Article I: Membership

Membership for the GIS and Mapping Club shall be divided into three categories: officers, members in good standing, and members not in good standing. All officers will have to abide by the responsibilities listed in *Article II: Selection of Officers*. Officers are expected to attend all meetings, unless extenuating circumstances prevent them from doing so. To stay in good standing, members must have consistent attendance at club meetings and events. There shall be no other requirements for membership. Members in good standing will have a say in the officer elections. On the other hand, members not in good standing may not have a say in the officer elections, although they shall not be prohibited from attending club-related gatherings.

Members who remain inactive for two consecutive semesters or are no longer attending Furman University may be removed from the club's rosters, SyncDIN, and GroupMe. However, these members will be eligible to rejoin the club at any time and regain good standing.

Article II: Selection of Officers

Elections will be held at the end of every academic year and will be guided by the following rules:

1. No member shall be forced into a position or be appointed without a vote.
2. Each member shall be elected into their respective position through a secret ballot during one of the general body meetings.
3. A member can only contest for one position during an election.
4. Each member of the club shall have one vote.
5. A sitting president shall be ineligible to vote and unable to campaign for a specific member in any way.

The roles and responsibilities of each club officer are as follows:

PRESIDENT

The president will:

1. Chair all club meetings.
2. Supervise the other officers of the club, ensuring the effective execution of responsibilities.
3. Represent the club at events requiring a delegation.
4. Lead the club on trips to specific events, including conferences, both in the United States and abroad.
5. Facilitate effective collaboration with faculty, other student organizations, as well as external organizations.

VICE PRESIDENT

The Vice President will:

1. Assist the president in managing club activities.
2. Drive strategic long-term planning of activities, in consultation with other key members.
3. Perform all the functions of the President in their absence.

TREASURER

The Treasurer shall:

1. Oversee the club's financial transactions, handling credit cards, receipts, and online orders.
2. Maintain transparency in financial matters by providing regular reports to club officers on how the club's money is spent.
3. Ensure that the total cost of events planned by the club stays within the limits of its budget allocations.

Social media/Media representative

The media representative shall:

1. Be responsible for managing the different social media accounts: Instagram, Facebook, and GroupMe.
2. Oversee publications throughout campus and the club's online presence. This includes flyers, posters, and Instagram aesthetics.
3. Appeal to the general student population to join the club.

SECRETARY

The secretary shall:

1. Maintain minutes and records of club meetings.
2. Send a recap of the meeting minutes by email and in the club group chat.
3. Manage communication between club members and officers.
4. Keep track of meeting attendance and the list of club members.

If an officer steps down or is incapable of performing their duties for some reason, an election shall be held to fill this position during the next body meeting. All new officers elected this way will have to run for reelection during the next regularly scheduled election. If deemed necessary, an officer may be removed from their position according to the steps outlined in *Article V: Rules of Order*.

Article III: Advisor Selection

The club advisor(s) shall be chosen by mutual agreement between the faculty or staff member(s) and the officers. The advisor(s) may be removed if they stop contributing to the club and communicating with its officers after the end of a semester. Removal of the advisor(s) requires approval by two-thirds of all officers and members in good standing. The advisor(s) may also choose to step down voluntarily.

Article IV: Committees

When necessary, the club president will define committees, outlining their purpose and the roles of committee members. Members of the club who wish to form a committee shall bring it up during regularly scheduled club meetings or contact the president directly.

Article V: Rules of Order

Any conflicts that arise in the club shall be handled without involving unrelated parties and non-officer members of the club. Members who violate the mission or rules of the club may be sanctioned only after prior approval is obtained from the Dean of Students Office. This shall apply regardless of whether a Furman University policy was also violated. The nature of the sanction (for example, removal from the club or suspension for a given duration) will first be discussed privately among club officers and the advisor(s). Officers shall not punish a member for conduct unrelated to the club's functions or conduct that occurred outside of club-related gatherings.

Organizations may not address a member's violations of university policy via internal standards boards or other accountability mechanisms without prior approval of the Dean of Students Office. Conduct expectations unique to membership in the organization and that do not overlap or otherwise interfere with university authority may be addressed with the written approval of the AVP/Dean of Students or designee. Groups affiliated with national organizations that have established guidance and procedures over disciplinary matters, may follow the directive of those national organizations with regard to member conduct but must do so with written approval of the university.

Article VI: Amendments

Amendments to the Constitution and Bylaws may be proposed by any officer or member in good standing. Proposals for amending the constitution must be submitted in writing to club officers and discussed at a general meeting. A majority vote of the club's officers is required for adoption of this amendment.